

044. Chapter 4 Verses 4-6

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 4.4

अर्जुन उवाच ।
अपरं भवतो जन्म परं जन्म विवस्वतः ।
कथमेतद्विजानीयां त्वमादौ प्रोक्तवानिति ॥ ४ ॥

arjuna uvāca |
aparaṁ bhavato janma
paraṁ janma vivasvataḥ |
kathametadvijānīyāṁ
tvamādau proktavāniti ||

- ◆ **arjunaḥ uvāca** – Arjuna said;
- ◆ **aparam** – later; **bhavataḥ** – Your; **janma** – birth;
- ◆ **param** – prior/ancient; **janma** – birth; **vivasvataḥ** – of Vivasvan;
- ◆ **katham** – how; **etat** – this; **vijānīyām** – should I understand;
- ◆ **tvam** – You; **ādau** – in the beginning; **proktavān** – taught; **iti** – thus.

Arjuna said: Later was your birth, earlier the birth of Vivasvan (Sun); how then am I to understand that you taught it to him in the beginning?

VERSE 4.5

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
बहूनि मे व्यतीतानि जन्मानि तव चार्जुन ।
तान्यहं वेद सर्वाणि न त्वं वेत्थ परन्तप ॥ 5 ॥*

śrībhagavānuvāca |
bahūni me vyatītāni
janmāni tava cārjuna |
tānyaham veda sarvāṇi
na tvam vettha parantapa ||

- ◆ śrī-bhagavān uvāca – The Blessed Lord said;
- ◆ bahūni – many; me – My; vyatītāni – have passed;
- ◆ janmāni – births; tava – your; ca – and; arjuna – O Arjuna;
- ◆ tāni – them; aham – I; veda – know; sarvāṇi – all;
- ◆ na – not; tvam – you; vettha – know; parantapa – O scorcher of foes.

The Lord said: O Arjuna! Many births of Mine have passed as well as yours. I know them all but you know them not.

VERSE 4.6

अजोऽपि सन्नव्ययात्मा भूतानामीश्वरोऽपि सन् ।
प्रकृतिं स्वामधिष्ठाय सम्भवाम्यात्ममायया ॥ ६ ॥

ajo'pi sannavyayātmā
bhūtānāmīśvaro'pi san |
prakṛtiṃ svāmadhiṣṭhāya
sambhavāmyātmamāyayā ||

- ◆ **ajah** – unborn; **api** – although; **san** – being; **avyaya-ātmā** – imperishable Self;
- ◆ **bhūtānām** – of beings; **īśvaraḥ** – the Lord; **api** – although; **san** – being;
- ◆ **prakṛtim** – nature; **svām** – My own; **adhiṣṭhāya** – presiding over/governing;
- ◆ **sambhavāmi** – I manifest/come into being; **ātma-māyayā** – by My own Maya (creative power).

Though unborn and eternal in My being, the Lord and controller of all beings, controlling My own nature, I come into being by the power of My Maya-Sakti.